

1. OVERVIEW TAB

What This Tab Represents

Think of this page as:

Cluster Identity Card

Everything here describes the Kubernetes Control Plane.

What to Observe in Screenshot

Cluster Status

Active

Meaning:

API Server Running

Scheduler Running

Controller Manager Running

etcd Running

Kubernetes Version

1.35

This is NOT:

EC2 Version

Linux Version

Docker Version

This is:

Control Plane Version

API Server Endpoint

Example:

<https://xxxxx.eks.amazonaws.com>

This endpoint becomes the target of:

```
kubectl get nodes
```

```
kubectl get pods
```

```
kubectl apply -f deployment.yaml
```

OIDC Provider

Example:

<https://oidc.eks.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com/id/xxxx>

Future Use:

Pod Identity

IRSA

IAM Roles for Pods

Learning Note

At this stage:

Control Plane Exists

Worker Nodes Do Not Exist

Interview Note

Question:

What components exist immediately after EKS cluster creation?

Answer:

API Server

Scheduler

Controller Manager

etcd

NOT Worker Nodes

2. RESOURCES TAB

What This Tab Represents

This page displays Kubernetes objects stored inside:

etcd

What to Observe

CoreDNS Pods

Example:

coredns-xxxxx

Pending

coredns-yyyyy

Pending

Why Are They Pending?

Current architecture:

CoreDNS Pod

|

Needs Node

|

Nodes = 0

|

Pending

Learning Note

This is the first proof that:

Pods cannot run without Nodes

Architecture

Deployment

|

ReplicaSet

|

Pods

CoreDNS already exists as a Deployment.

3. COMPUTE TAB

What This Tab Represents

Where Kubernetes gets compute power.

Current Observation

Nodes = 0

Node Groups = 0

Fargate Profiles = 0

Relationship Explained

This answers:

Where does Auto Scaling Group fit?

Architecture:

Managed Node Group



Auto Scaling Group



EC2 Instances



Kubernetes Nodes



Pods

Learning Note

AWS hides the ASG from most Kubernetes users.

But it still exists.

Interview Note

Question:

Does EKS automatically create EC2 instances?

Answer:

No

Cluster Creation

≠

Node Creation

4. NETWORKING TAB

What to Observe

VPC

vpc-xxxx

All cluster resources live here.

Service CIDR

10.100.0.0/16

Used by:

Kubernetes Services

NOT:

EC2 Instances

Subnets

ap-south-1a

ap-south-1b

ap-south-1c

Provides Multi-AZ resiliency.

Cluster Security Group

Created automatically by EKS.

Used for:

Control Plane ↔ Nodes

communication.

Learning Note

Distinguish:

VPC CIDR

from:

Service CIDR

Very common confusion.

5. ADD-ONS TAB

CoreDNS

Provides:

DNS Resolution

Example:

backend-service

|



10.100.x.x

kube-proxy

Provides:

Service Routing

Amazon VPC CNI

Provides:

Pod Networking

and Pod IP allocation.

Golden Rule

Remember:

CoreDNS



Name Resolution

kube-proxy



Traffic Routing

VPC CNI



Pod Networking

6. CAPABILITIES TAB

Argo CD

GitOps platform.

GitHub



Argo CD



Kubernetes

ACK

AWS resources through Kubernetes.

Example:

kubectl apply



Creates S3 Bucket

KRO

Higher-level Kubernetes orchestration.

Learning Note

Skip these until Kubernetes fundamentals are mastered.

7. ACCESS TAB

Authentication Mode

EKS API + ConfigMap

Supports:

Modern Access Entries

Legacy aws-auth

IAM Access Entries

Controls:

Who can access cluster?

Pod Identity

Controls:

What AWS resources can Pods access?

Architecture

Pod



IAM Role



S3

Secrets Manager

DynamoDB

8. OBSERVABILITY TAB

Control Plane Logs Enabled

API Server

Audit

Authenticator

Purpose

Answer:

What happened?

Who did it?

When did it happen?

Future Tools

Prometheus

Grafana

CloudWatch

9. UPDATE HISTORY & BACKUPS

Update History

Tracks:

Cluster Upgrades

Add-on Upgrades

Configuration Changes

Backups

Protects:

Deployments

Services

Secrets

ConfigMaps